

Competitive landscape

One hundred and five companies read, eighteen measured against the job, and the three market shapes that decide who keeps the value.

Competitive diligence

Research cut August 2026

Public information only

4orm Finance · Confidential

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Three parts. Who is in the field, where each one stops, and what the shape of the market says.

01 · The field, read one company at a time	One hundred and five companies against twelve capability categories. · page 3
02 · Where they stop	Eighteen rivals measured against the eight parts of the job, and the four walls each one stops at. · page 7
03 · What the market shape says	Three precedents, two of them uncomfortable. · page 14

Exhibits

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Exhibit 2	Parts of the job covered, by firm, out of eight. · page 12
Exhibit 3	How many of the eighteen ship each part. · page 13

Overlap is a structured feature comparison. It is not a market-share estimate. Every mark comes from public material read in the August 2026 cut. A blank category means the capability was not observed as something the company is bought for. It is not proof the company cannot build it.

01 • THE FIELD

The primitives are crowded. The assembly is not.

428

 core marks across 105 companies

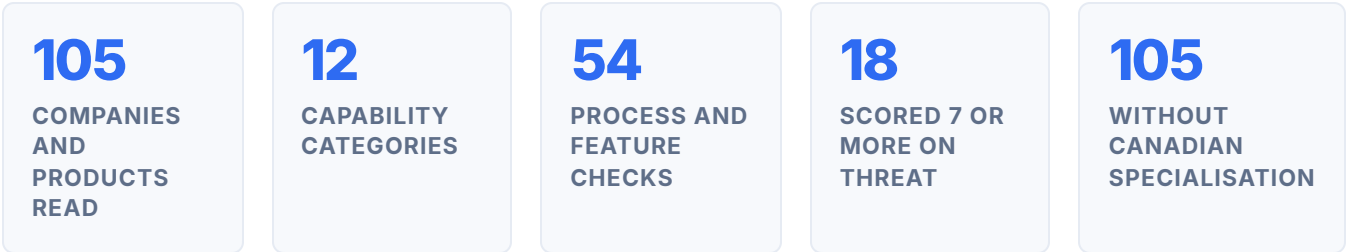
Evidence, consent, case management, reconciliation, drafting and connectivity each have established vendors with capital behind them. Almost none of them sit together in one system.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- No page in this book claims a category nobody has entered.
- Companies own pieces. The file is still assembled by hand at the end.
- Threat is two things: structured feature overlap, and the scale, capital and distribution that let a vendor reach the seam.

Source: public information only, research cut August 2026.

What the register covers



The register is deliberately wider than a competitor list. It holds direct products, vertical systems of record, infrastructure, governance tooling and adjacent platforms, because the strategic question is who can reach the seam, not who is selling against us this quarter.

The twelve categories, and what each one asks

#	CATEGORY	WHAT IT ASKS
1	Consumer understanding	What the customer was told and understood.
2	Suitability rationale	Why this product suited this customer.
3	Transaction and case record	The authoritative record of the file.
4	Evidence and provenance	Where each fact came from.
5	Consent and privacy	What the customer agreed to, and when.
6	Cross-system ingestion	Pulling records in from other systems.
7	Rules and compliance controls	The rules the file is tested against.
8	Human approval	Who signed, and on what.
9	Change and version history	What changed, when, and by whose hand.
10	Complaint evidence	What happened when the customer complained.
11	Regulator and audit outputs	The pack an examiner is handed.
12	Cross-vertical portability	The same system across more than one industry.

Reading a mark

Three states, and they always sum to 105.

Core	The company markets or structurally owns the capability, and it is part of what a buyer is paying for.
Partial	The capability exists but is secondary, configurable, or confined to one workflow. Present, not the product.
Not observed	Not a central public capability in this scan. A research finding, not a claim about what the company could build.

The four thinnest rows, and what each one is

05 Consent and privacy	5 of 105 core, 84 adjacent, 16 where nothing was found.
10 Complaint evidence	10 of 105 core, 63 adjacent, 32 where nothing was found.
12 Cross-vertical portability	16 of 105 core, 30 adjacent, 59 where nothing was found.
01 Consumer understanding	17 of 105 core, 43 adjacent, 45 where nothing was found.

The seam is the assembly, and the assembly is what nobody sells.

A firm serving a consumer in a regulated transaction owes a complete file: what the customer understood, why the product suited them, what they consented to, what the systems actually did, who signed, and what changed. Each of those has a vendor. The complete file does not.

Where the register runs thin

The bar is the number of companies out of 105 that hold the capability as a core strength.

EXHIBIT 1 · CORE CAPABILITY BY CATEGORY, OUT OF 105 COMPANIES



Bars start at zero and run to 105, the full register. The note beside each bar gives the partial and not-observed counts, so the three states always sum to 105. Source: public information only, research cut August 2026.

428

CORE MARKS

581

PARTIAL MARKS

251

NOT OBSERVED

02 · WHERE THEY STOP

Eighteen rivals, and none holds all eight.

6 of eighteen ship a decision log

Every part of the job ships today inside at least one well funded firm. The case rests on where those firms stop, and on how long they stay stopped.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- None of them is wrong. Nothing here rests on a rival being bad at its job.
- All of them stop somewhere: at a price, at a border or at a rule. The stop is built in.
- Every stop has a shelf life. Good for about two quarters, then the map is run again.

Sources: each firm's own product pages read 4 August 2026. The wall is our own reading.

The four walls

Every rival stops at one of four walls before it reaches the buyer.

Price	They cannot reach our price without breaking their own model.
Scope	They own one piece of the job, not the job.
Border	Built for another country's rules.
Rules	The one wall that can move. Canadian rule content is the gap.
Not a rival	More likely to sell for us than against us.

Seventeen of these walls hold, and one of them can move.

Price, scope and border are structural. A firm changes those only by changing what it is. Rule content is different: any funded vendor can choose to build Canadian rule content, which is why the rules wall is the one to watch and the one with the shortest shelf life.

Where each rival stops

RIVAL	HOME	WHAT IT DOES	WALL	WHERE IT STOPS
Workiva	US	Joined up reporting, locked record	Border	Large firm reporting, with no Canadian rule content.
Vanta	US	Non stop control proof, trust pages	Border	Security rules, not consumer transaction rules, and Canada would not be its first rule maker.
Drata	US	Control proof with locked change records	Border	Security rules, not consumer transaction rules. The closer of the two to a rule maker.
Alessa, in CaseWare	Canada	Five report types for money movers	Scope	Money laundering work, and nothing in the consumer transaction record.
Unit21	US	Case work and filing in many countries	Scope	Files Canadian money laundering reports, not the consumer transaction duties.
Case IQ	Canada	Case handling across ten trades	Scope	Case handling, with no rule content and no decision log.
Resolver, in Kroll	Canada	Risk, audit and inquiry work	Scope	Wide risk work, not the consumer transaction and not the file behind it.
SimpleRisk	US	Open core risk and rule software	Scope	A risk register at a low price, with no Canadian rule content.
Fairly AI	Canada	Model and machine learning oversight	Scope	Built for model oversight, not for the consumer transaction record.
Nasdaq Verafin	Canada	Financial crime work at 2,800 banks	Price	Will not meet us in the small firm market.
ServiceNow	US	Wide risk platform on a work engine	Price	Set up runs up to two and a half times the licence.
Archer	US	Wide risk platform, long established	Price	Enterprise pricing. It cannot reach our price at all.
MetricStream	US	Enterprise risk and rule platform	Price	Sold to very large firms, from half a million dollars up.
LogicGate	US	Configurable risk platform	Price	Mid market pricing, and set up work on top of it.
Optro	US	Connected risk, controls and testing	Price	Audit and control work at a price the buyer cannot carry.
Diligent	US	Eight modules, audit and third party risk	Price	Priced above the full duty set, for a different job.

Product pages read 4 August 2026. The wall is our own reading.

Three near neighbours, not rivals

PARTY	HOME	WHAT IT DOES	WALL	WHERE IT STOPS
Buying groups and Celero	Canada	Buy software for credit unions	Not a rival	A gate rather than a rival. Treat it as a way in.
Yardi, AppFolio, Buildium	US	Property software with trust book keeping	Not a rival	Book keeping is not a proof file.
Regulators and rule makers	Canada	Could publish a free template	Not a rival	A template is not a habit, and none has published one.

Three things are true of every name in this paper.

None of them is wrong. All of them stop somewhere, and the stop is built in. Every stop has a shelf life of about two quarters, and then the map has to be run again.

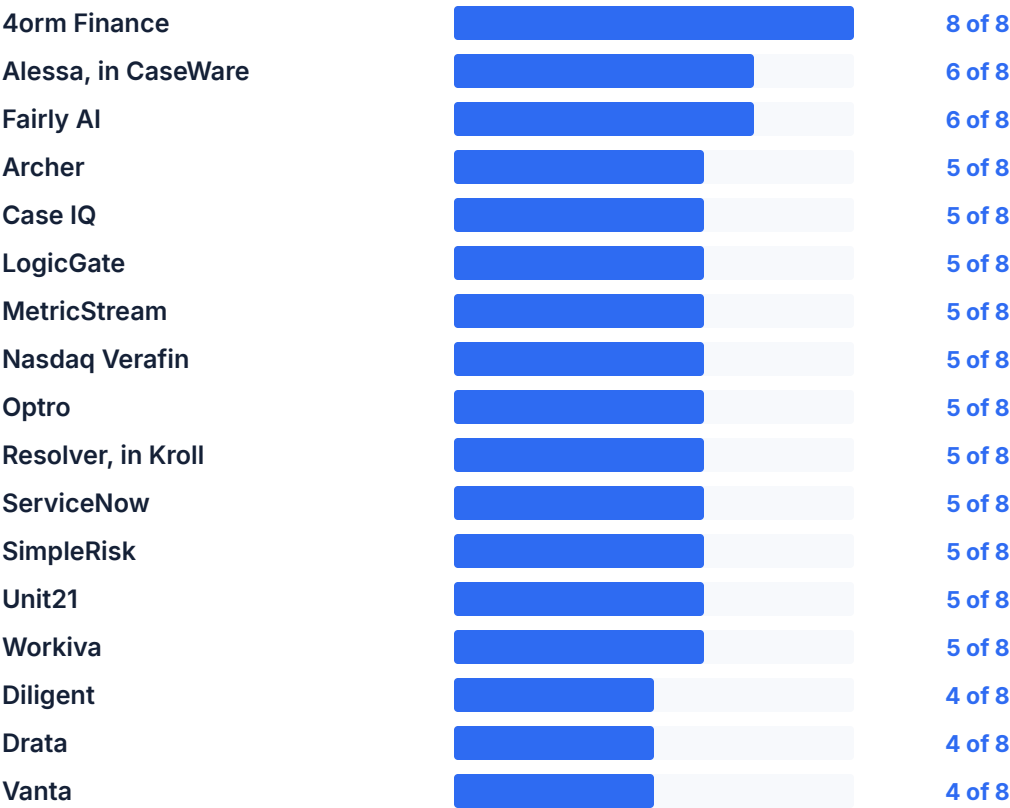
The eight parts of the job

01 Case handling	One place to run an issue from opening to close.
02 Proof store	Where the evidence is kept and pulled back out.
03 Decision log	What was decided, by whom, and under which rule.
04 Approval steps	Who signs, and in what order, before a thing counts as done.
05 Change record	A record of any change, so nothing can be quietly rewritten.
06 Regulator output	Sending the finished return or pack to the regulator.
07 Canadian rules	Canadian rule content, kept up to date in the product.
08 Under \$35,000	A yearly price a fifty person firm approves without a committee.

A part counts only where the firm's own published pages say it ships. This is our reading of public product pages as at 4 August 2026.

How much of the job each firm covers

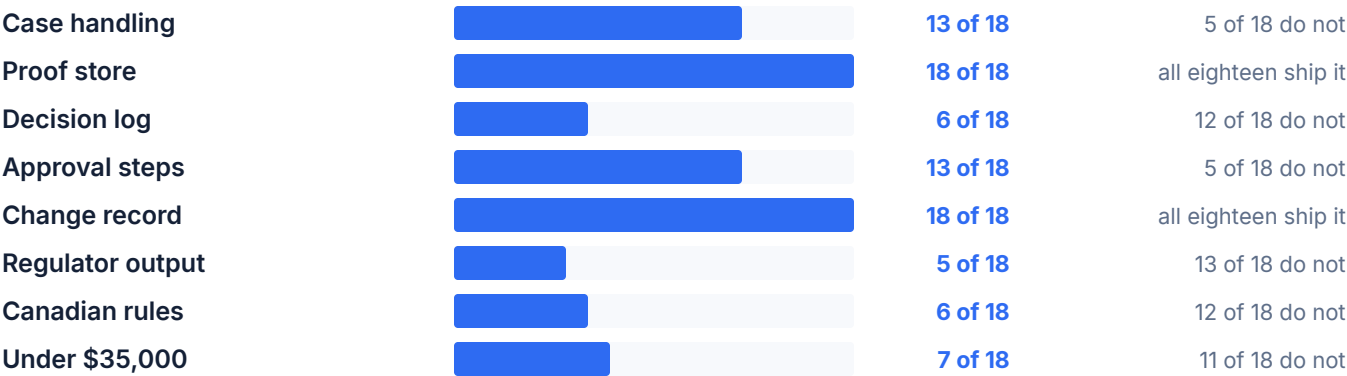
EXHIBIT 2 · PARTS OF THE JOB COVERED, OUT OF EIGHT



Bars start at zero and run to eight. Sorted by parts covered. Our reading of published product pages as at 4 August 2026.

The four thinnest parts, counted

EXHIBIT 3 · HOW MANY OF THE EIGHTEEN SHIP EACH PART



Bars start at zero and run to eighteen, the full set measured. Our reading of published product pages as at 4 August 2026.

Holding all four at once is the crossing point.

The decision log, the regulator output, Canadian rule content and a price a fifty person firm approves without a committee are the four thinnest parts. Nothing here says the field is empty. Every part of the job ships today inside at least one well funded firm.

03 · MARKET SHAPE

Three precedents, two of them uncomfortable.

4 proof exchanges built, four swallowed

Two of these three shapes went against the firm that built them. The third is the one this plan sits in.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Whoever owns the way in owns the market. We do not own a way in and are not trying to build one.
- A middle place nobody has to use does not hold.
- The duty cannot be handed to anybody else. It stays with the firm.

Sources: the bank messaging body's own count of member banks; published records of four proof exchanges and the sales that ended them. The judgement in the third shape is our own.

The network owner wins

A bank messaging body runs a know your customer register used by more than **7,000** banks. It won because it controlled the way in, not because its product was better than the alternatives.

The neutral exchange does not

Four independent proof exchanges were built and all four were swallowed by a bigger firm. One gathered **14,000** records against a target of **250,000**. A middle place nobody is obliged to use does not hold.

The firm that owes the duty can be sold to

This is the line the plan turns on. We sell a way of doing a job the firm owns itself and cannot hand to anyone. The duty stays with the firm, and it stays there every day.

Each shape is the same question drawn three ways.

Who joins, who owns the middle, and who ends up holding the value. Two of the three shapes took the value away from the firm that built the thing. The third leaves it with the firm that owes the duty, which is where we sell.

What we would grant in a room with any of them

They have more money	Vanta reports 16,000 customers and US\$300M of annual recurring revenue on its own count, April 2026 . Several names here sit inside far larger groups.
They are better built	These are grown up products with years of hardening in them. We would not win a feature comparison on maturity.
And none of it reaches the buyer	A Canadian firm with fifty people, a duty on every consumer transaction, and an examiner who asks for the file afterwards.

Every stop has a shelf life.

Each wall in this document is good for about two quarters. The rules wall is the one that can move, because any funded vendor can choose to build Canadian rule content. Re-run this map on that cycle.

Sources: public information only, research cut August 2026. Product pages read 4 August 2026. Company scale figures are each firm's own published claims.



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People · Trust · Clear Outcomes

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